

and other governance related data. A compromise of servers containing sensitive data (especially military data) can make a huge impact on the future of this planet depending on what information was extracted from where and when. Control over weapon deployment systems could finish a war even before it started by using the weapons designed by a country against itself. Control over large weapon systems such as missiles may lead to catastrophic results.

The possibilities do not end here. If the hackers who penetrate systems with critical data might be able to change the data as well, it could result in change of long term plans and mislead entire operations into traps. Deleting data can cause complete disorganization and void plans. Under high stress conditions, this can prove fatal to a significant portion of the world's population.

Motivation to Sabotage Civil Life

When critical systems get connected to a common central network, the possibility of bringing them down becomes easier than it would have been otherwise. Electricity is at the heart of what we do in our day to day life. Bringing an electrical grid offline can cause massive service disruption as all other information infrastructure depends on electricity. There have been known attacks on US electrical power grids already. (<http://news.bbc.co.uk/2/hi/technology/7990997.stm>). In case the power grid is nuclear, an attack on the control systems can potentially convert the power source into a nuclear bomb (once again depending on what depth the hack went to).

Electrical grids are not the only targets in cyber warfare. Other resources such as public transportation, communication, water and fuel are also increasingly being monitored and controlled using computing systems for the sake of automation. A successful attack on any of these can open a gate of immense troubles which can potentially bring a country to a standstill, as we have already discussed in the Cyberterrorism chapter.

Financial Motivation - harming the competition

Bots such as stuxnet which can manipulate manufacturing processes of other equipments by hacking the logic of a PLC (Programmable Logic Chip, used in automation of assembly lines) pose a huge threat to the manufacturing processes of various equipments. An attack on manufacturing units and factories can cause huge losses to a nation too, not to mention the company which owns the factory. And we did not even count using